myself and that I would have been dreadfully unhappy if

I had not been permitted to do this. I would rather have written the parodies than do any of the vacation things that everyone else was doing. (When it was all over, the owners of the resort gave me a twenty-dollar rebate for my help, but I just turned it over to the waiters.)

On July 26, Gertrude and I celebrated our eighth anniversary, and since we had made no secret that it was coming, the Annisquam management brought out a cake. Someone yelled "Speech!" and everyone was thunderstruck and perhaps a little chagrined when I promptly got up and made one. Apparently, it was customary to shout "Speech!" and equally customary for the honored couple to be entirely too bashful to oblige.

*3

By the time we got back to Boston, the situation in Korea was at its lowest ebb. The Americans had been forced into the southeastern corner of the country, around the port of Pusan.

What selfishly struck me as more important, however, was that the dealer had my car. I spent all of August 7 having them put in various accessories that I wanted and signing up for insurance. On August 8, 1950, at the age of thirty, I owned my first car.

Combine that with the fact that writing earnings kept pouring in, and I was a happy man. My share of the Unicorn Mystery publication of Pebble in the Sky came in, together with news of further anthologi-zations of this story and that. There was also a report of the sale of second serial rights to Pebble in the Sky. (I didn't even know what that meant till it was explained to me. It turned out to mean magazine publication after the book appearance. First serial rights involves magazine publication before book appearance.)

On Wednesday, August 9, I drove my car to work for the first time and hardly got lost, just a little bit on the way back. On Friday, I tanked up with gasoline for the first time. It cost nearly 27 cents a gallon, and I was appalled at the expense. I was also aware, for the first time, of the dreadful conditions of the streets. Every bang and rattle the potholes imposed on my car were so many stabs to my vitals.

The real test came on August 12, when, at the Boyds' invitation, we drove to their summer place. It took us 4V4 hours to get there, driving very slowly, and 3V2 hours to get back, driving more quickly. We traveled 176 miles round-